



TIPS & TRICKS



Listing the number of directories owned by users

To list the users that own the highest number of directories on the filesystem, use the following command:

```
ls -l <path> | awk '{ print $3 }' | sort | uniq -c | sort -n -r
```

—Vinit Khandagle,
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Making terminal keystrokes invisible while typing

To make characters invisible in the terminal while typing from the keyboard, use the following command:

```
$stty -echo
```

To get back to the default option, type:

```
$stty echo
```

To clear the 'history' of your command, type:

```
$history -c
```

—Benedict Nicholas,
benedictnicholas@yahoo.com



Search the possible man pages for your keyword

If you want to know which command to use for a particular need of yours, just use a keyword to search the man pages for the commands related to this keyword. To search, you need to use the *appropos* command as shown below:

```
#appropos keywords
```

For example, if you want to know the commands for the keyword 'search', just type the following command to display these:

```
#appropos search
```

—Yakub Pasha Shaik,
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Check your mouse using cat!

Whenever you are confused about whether your mouse is working or not, you can check it with the help of the *cat* command in Linux. This is really handy while troubleshooting a remote system using the terminal.

```
$sudo cat/dev/psaux
```

After issuing the command, move your mouse, and if you see characters floating on your screen, it indicates that your mouse is working.

—Jatin Dhankhar,
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Rename multiple files

To rename all files from a given directory, we can use the *xargs* command as shown below:

```
[bash]$ ls -l | xargs -t -i mv {} {}.new_extention.
```

—Narendra Kangralkar,
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Disable the beeping sound in the bash terminal

In Red Hat Linux 4 or 5, while working in the terminal mode, pressing *TAB* results in a beep. To stop this sound, follow the steps given below:

Open your */etc/inputrc* file:

```
$ vi /etc/inputrc
```

Remove # to uncomment the following line:

```
set bell-style none
```

Save and close the file.

Now press *TAB* to auto complete a command and you will no longer hear any beep.

—Suresh Jagtap,
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